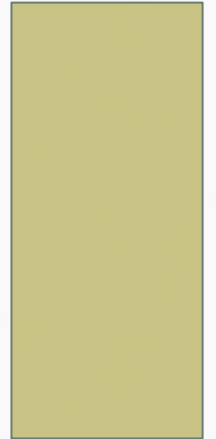


CONSIDERING COMMUNICATION MODELS

TEAMS-ETHICS-ACCESS



TEAM BUILDING

UNDERSTANDING ROLES & WORK FLOW

GROUPS VS. TEAMS

- Groups
 - 2+ people interacting & influencing each other. (usu. 3 w/upward limit, 5 people are ideal limit)
 - A collection of individuals
- Teams: (smart groups) 2+ people who...
 - share leadership
 - create a shared identity
 - exert interconnected efforts in order to achieve mutually defined goals.
- Teams are Groups, BUT Groups are not Teams
- Teams plan and talk in advance...

GROUPS VS. TEAMS

- A group doesn't talk about ways of making decisions, it just does it.
- Teams talk about the proper way to make decisions.
 - Teams are more likely to make decisions about the way decision-making occurs b/c they are concerned with equality, about how they do their job...

TUCKMAN'S 4 STAGES OF TEAMING

- Forming: the “getting-to-know-you” phase, team members assess strengths and abilities of each other.
- Storming: managing conflict within the team
- Norming: determining team roles
- Performing: improving the process in ways that improve the quality of the work.

FORMING: ROLES OF TEAM MEMBERS

- Formal Roles -- "public" roles (elected, appointed) chair, timekeeper, etc
- Informal (Mudrack & Farrell, 1995) (personalities of the members of the group) roles that people bring with them
 - Task: concerned about getting the work done
 - Social:- making sure everyone is feeling included and belonging
 - Disruptive: person who doesn't want to talk about the items at hand they prefer to talk about other stuff

STORMING: PLANNING TO MINIMIZE CONFLICT

- Define Team Member Responsibilities
 - Coordinator
 - Researchers
 - Editor
 - Designer
- Create a Project Calendar
- Write out a Work Plan
- Agree on How conflicts will be resolved
 - Efficacy vs. efficiency

STORMING: HOW TO PROBLEM-SOLVE

- What is the problem, task, opportunity?
- Define the problem, task, opportunity.
- Identify & agree on criteria for solution.
- Generate possible solutions (quantity).
- Select a solution.
- Develop implementation.
- Develop review procedure.

ACCOMPLISHING TASKS

- Establish a procedure and process of workflow
- Create parameters for decision making (either formally such as by-laws, or informally by consensus).

STORMING: MANAGING CONFLICT

- Choose a mediator
- Ask both sides to state their position
- Identify the issues
- Prioritize the issues from most to least important
- Address each issue separately, trying to find middle ground
- Write down an agreement that both sides can accept

NORMING: IDENTIFYING TEAM ROLES

- People-oriented Roles
 - Coordinator—sets agenda
 - Resource investigator—finds information, ideas
 - Team worker—gets the work done
- Action-oriented roles
 - Shaper—looks for patterns within team tasks, emphasizes completion
 - Implementor—likes to turn abstract ideas into concrete deliverables
 - Completer/finisher—stresses attention to details & quality of work

NORMING: IDENTIFYING TEAM ROLES

- Cerebral roles
 - Monitor/evaluator—keep team on task w/critique of poor decisions & flaws in reasoning.
 - Plant—thinks creatively, stresses innovation & big picture
 - Specialist—contributes special skill & knowledge to the team.

PERFORMING: PLANNING TO COMPLETE A PROJECT

- Define Project Mission & Objectives
 - Subject (what are we asked to do? Not to do? What are the parameters/boundaries of project)
 - Purpose (mission statement)
 - Readers (who are our clients?)
 - Context (What are the physical, economic, political, and ethical factors that influence this project?)
- Identify Project Outcomes
 - Tangible results of project
 - Convert objectives into measurable results
 - Specify the deliverables that the project will produce.
 - See Case Study on p. 67, TCT

COMMUNICATION MODELS

TRANSACTION & CMAPP

WHAT IS COMMUNICATION MODELING

- Used to explain the way people exchange information.
- Think of it as a way to describe or illustrate communication more broadly...allowing TC writers to determine the best approach for each project.

TERMS TO KNOW

- **Source**—in models of communication, a person who creates and sends a message to receivers
- **Message**—verbal or non-verbal ideas that a source conveys through the communication process

TERMS TO KNOW CONT.

- **Encode**—to choose a verbal or nonverbal symbols to organize and deliver one's message
- **Decode**—to interpret a message by making sense of a source's verbal and non-verbal symbols.
 - Decoding is performed by a receiver.

TERMS TO KNOW CONT.

- **Verbal symbols**—a spoken, written, or recorded word that a source uses to convey a message
- **Nonverbal symbols**—a means of communication without using words.
 - Examples: gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, & images

TERMS TO KNOW CONT.

- **Receivers**—one who possesses a message to perceive its meaning.
- **Noise/interference**—external or internal phenomena that disrupt communication between a sender and a receiver.
 - **External** sources include nearby loud noise
 - **Internal** sources might include wandering thoughts of the sender or receiver.

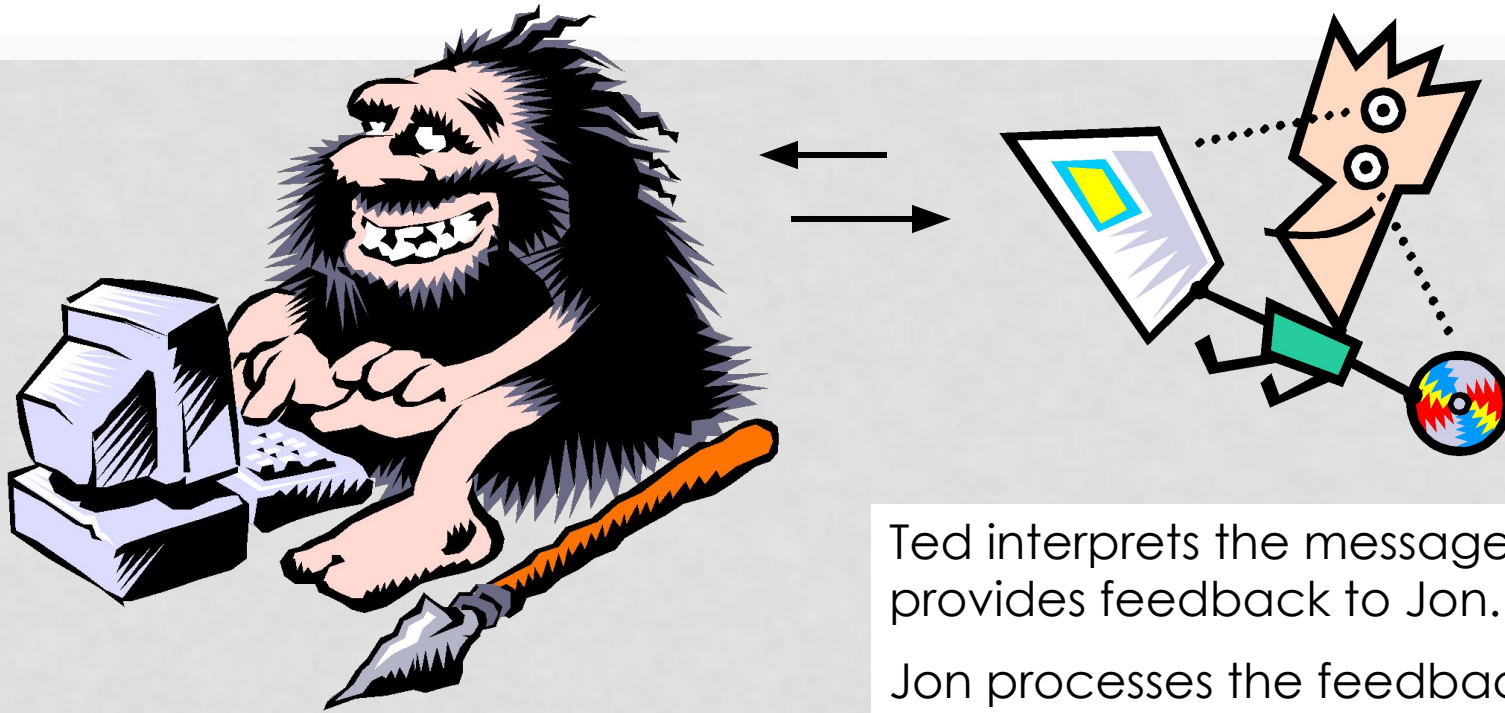
TERMS TO KNOW CONT.

- **Transaction**—a communication exchange in which all participants continuously send and receive messages.
- **Feedback**—an audience's verbal and nonverbal responses to a source's message

TERMS TO KNOW CONT.

- **Shared meaning**—a common understanding with little confusion and few misinterpretations.
 - Achieving shared meaning is a priority of the transactional model of communication.

SIMPLE TRANSACTION MODEL



Jon (sender) wants to send a message to Ted (receiver).

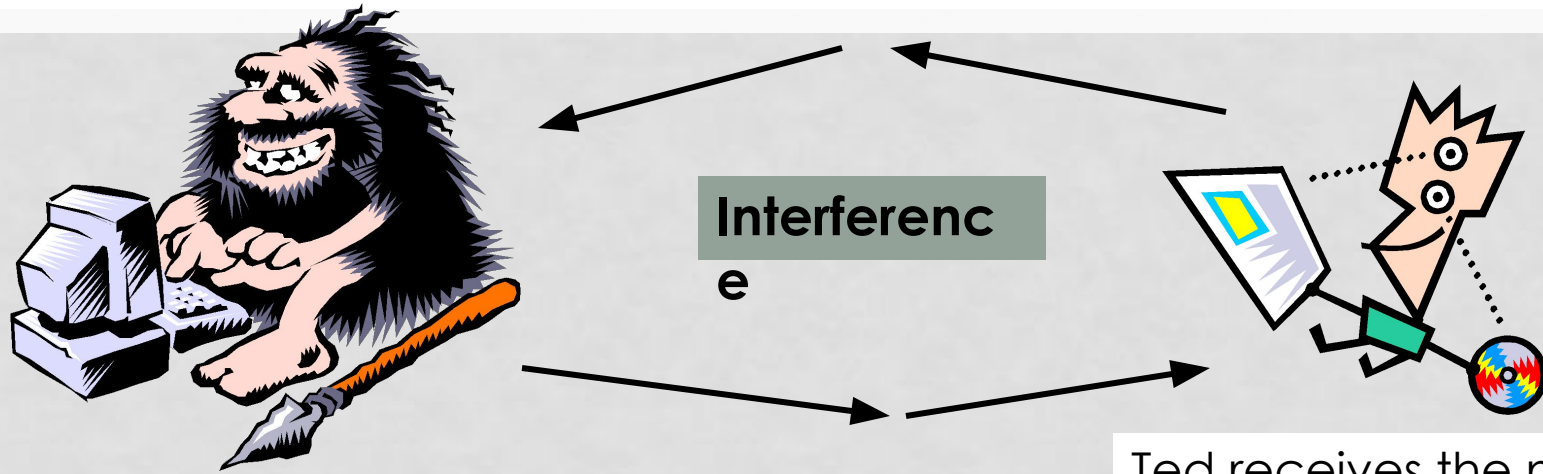
Ted interprets the message and provides feedback to Jon.

Jon processes the feedback and modifies the message.

INTERFERENCE TRANSACTION MODEL

- Builds upon the simple transaction model by adding the concept of **interference**, both internal and external.
 - **External interference** is the surrounding noise and distraction that serves as obstacles to communication (ex. a crying baby).
 - **Internal interference** may be subjective, a person's inability to concentrate because of mental fatigue, or the inability to remain objective towards the topic.

INTERFERENCE TRANSACTION MODEL

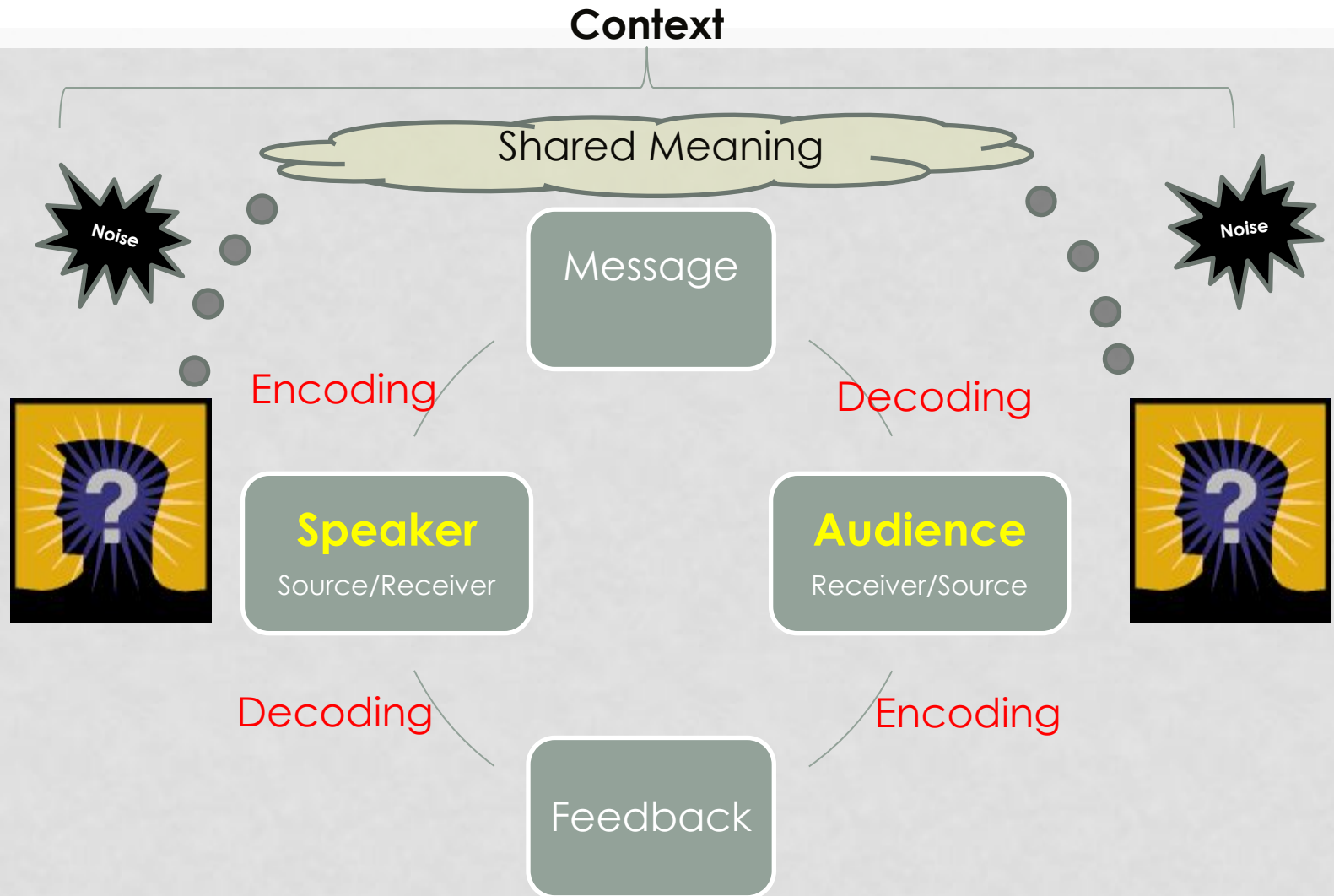


Jon (sender) wants to send a message to Ted (receiver) but can't.

Jon encodes the message by determining structure and content.

Ted receives the message and then decodes message and provides feedback.

INTERFERENCE TRANSACTION MODEL OF COMMUNICATION



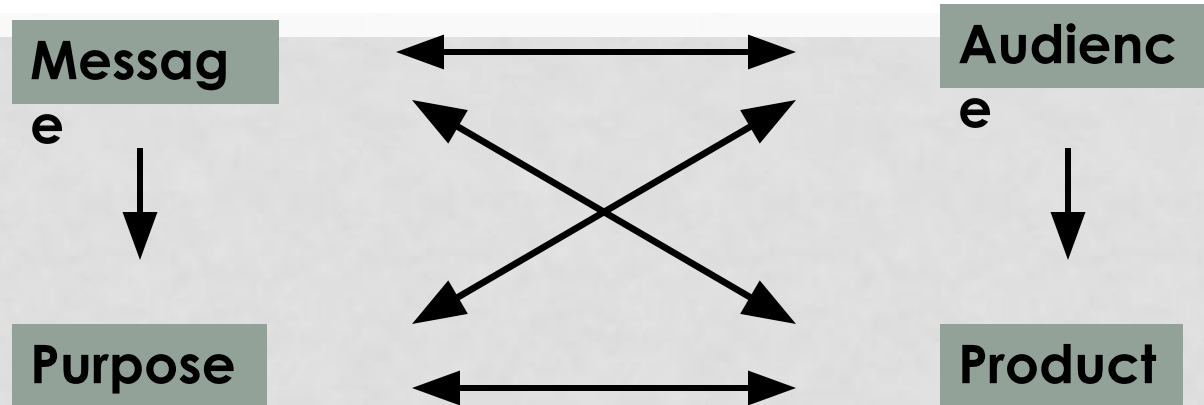
CMAPP COMMUNICATION MODEL

- CMAPP—a better model for tech comm.
 - Context,
 - Message,
 - Audience,
 - Purpose,
 - Product
- This model applies to technical communication by omitting the sender, receiver, and transmission elements.
- Instead, CMAPP incorporates the following ideas...

CMAPP MODEL

- Situations (the **context**) in which people find themselves affect their communication.
- What people say (the **message**) is affected by the person or group with whom they are communicating (the **audience**).
- What people communicate is affected by their reason for communicating and their expectations (the **purpose**).
- The physical form of the communication (the **product** affects the way in which the communication is formulated and received.)

CMAAPP COMMUNICATION MODEL



The **message** effects the **audience** to which the communication is directed.

The **purpose** affects the intent of the **message**.

The **product** refers to the technical document.

Each element impacts and affects the others continuously.

CMAPP MODEL CONTINUED

- All these ideas affect each other all the time.
- The first step to creating effective technical communication is conducting a CMAPP analysis.

CMAPP ANALYSIS

- Context
 - What is the underlying or surrounding situation?
 - What are the physical conditions (lighting, noise, etc.)?
 - How will the context affect how my audience responds to me or my message?
 - What is my relationship with my audience?
 - What other relationships involved might have an impact?

CMAPP ANALYSIS CONTINUED

- Message
 - What exactly am I trying to communicate?
 - Is it a message worth communicating?
 - Is my message self-contained, or is it the initial, middle, or final segment of a longer communication?
 - Have I included all necessary and excluded all unnecessary information?
 - Have I provided the specifics that my audience will need and/or want?
 - Do I have more than one message (i.e., one or more secondary messages)?
 - If I have more than one message, have I arranged them in an order that is appropriate for this context, audience, and purpose?
 - Am I the best person to send this message or should the message come from someone else?

CMAPP ANALYSIS CONTINUED

- Audience
 - Who should receive my communication?
 - Who will receive it?
 - What does my audience know already?
 - What does my audience need to know?
 - What does my audience want to know?
 - What assumptions have I made about my audience?
 - How specialized (technical) is my audience?
 - How will my audience benefit from my communication?

CMAPP ANALYSIS CONTINUED

- Purpose
 - Why should my audience need or want this communication?
 - What do I want to achieve?
 - Am I trying to inform, persuade, instruct, or describe?
 - Was my communication explicitly requested?
 - Are there deadlines involved?
 - Have I identified and dealt with them?

CMAPP ANALYSIS CONTINUED

- Product
 - Should I be writing, phoning, or visiting?
 - Have I chosen a product (e.g. letter, memo, report, presentation) that is appropriate for this context, audience, message, and purpose?
 - Do the wording and format of my product reflect the image I want to present?

CMAAPP SCENARIO

- You receive an envelope that is supposed to contain a check and an explanatory note.
- The note is there; but the check is not.
- What do you do?
- Use the CMAAPP approach...